

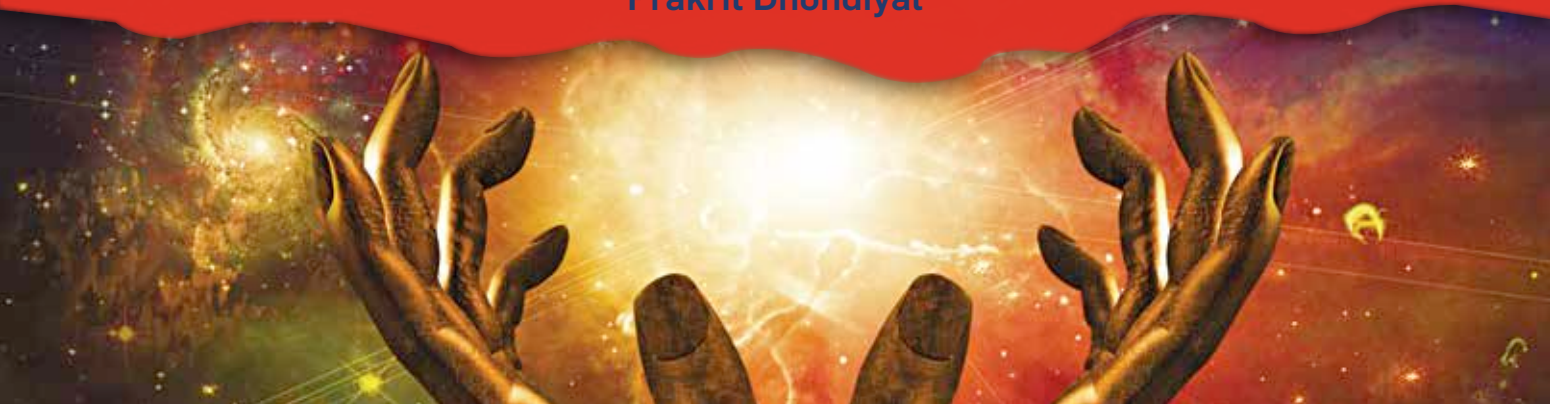


GOD VS SCIENCE



You'd think Digit votes science right? Wrong! We're not choosing sides, we never do. We just examine the evidence

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Yes. That old question again. Why? Well, because it never really gets old. And while people keep talking about it, people like us shall oblige and print yet another article on the subject. So let us have a little chat about these two behemoths that have the world wrapped around their composite little fingers.

God's been around longer

Even if we take Darwin's theory of the origin of the species into account, saying that life on earth was a result of a confluence of favourable events (just the right conditions in the ocean at just the right time, creating the first single-celled organisms) a devout man would always argue with 'it was a higher power who set the ideal conditions'. And in the interest of giving credit where it is due, when mankind was walking around, fresh off the trees, club in hand, we didn't attribute lightning to an electrostatic discharge between the electrically charged regions within clouds or between a cloud and the surface of a planet. It was easier to blame superior, omniscient beings. Yes, back then it was more likely that that the gods of thunder, air, wind and sky were responsible. So in all due fairness, gods were the ones who set the worldly stage in our minds since time immemorial. They have helped human evolution at the spiritual level, taking the blame for anything that went wrong in the world, so that we could

concentrate on evolutionary progress. Without the training wheel that was a supreme power, humanity's evolution may not have proceeded in the direction history shows us it did. So score one for the Lord!

Score: Science: 0 / God: 1

But Science is all around us

Science has a one-up over the powers of Godliness – it's tangible. As mysterious as your supreme power's ways are, science has had the added advantage of being based on quantifiable and observable fact. Science has its own laws, which may be occasionally malleable and bend to accommodate new discoveries, but refuse to break. The one reason why reason is so popular is because people have an obvious tendency to believe the physical over the metaphysical. It's a page out of Plato's Theory of Forms.



God – in sickness and health

While the idea of something is purer and more appreciated, one must make do with the physical embodiment of the idea, since it is more palpable and can be physically experienced as opposed to the spiritual. Considering a huge chunk of the life that we do know exists is in the realm of the physical, it's not a big surprise that scientific advancement has been on a rise since before the term 'scientific advancement' was actually coined. The all-time favourite goal of humanity has always been to achieve the impossible – a goal that seems more within our grasp by the decade. Majority of these achievements being through science. Science takes a point, here.

Score: Science: 1 / God: 1

Battle of the Publishers

Cutting down to the core of proof of the existence of an all-powerful being, most religious people hold open their religious texts as proof that God (or his proclaimed son/prophet) existed and passed on teachings through his human delegates. Well, if holy texts are proof of God's existence, Stephen Hawking and Leonard Mlodinow's book 'The Grand Design' is the counter-argument debunking the claim that the Universe was created by one or even many beings. The core statement of their 'Multiverse' argument is to explain "the fine tuning of physical law without the need for a benevolent creator who made the